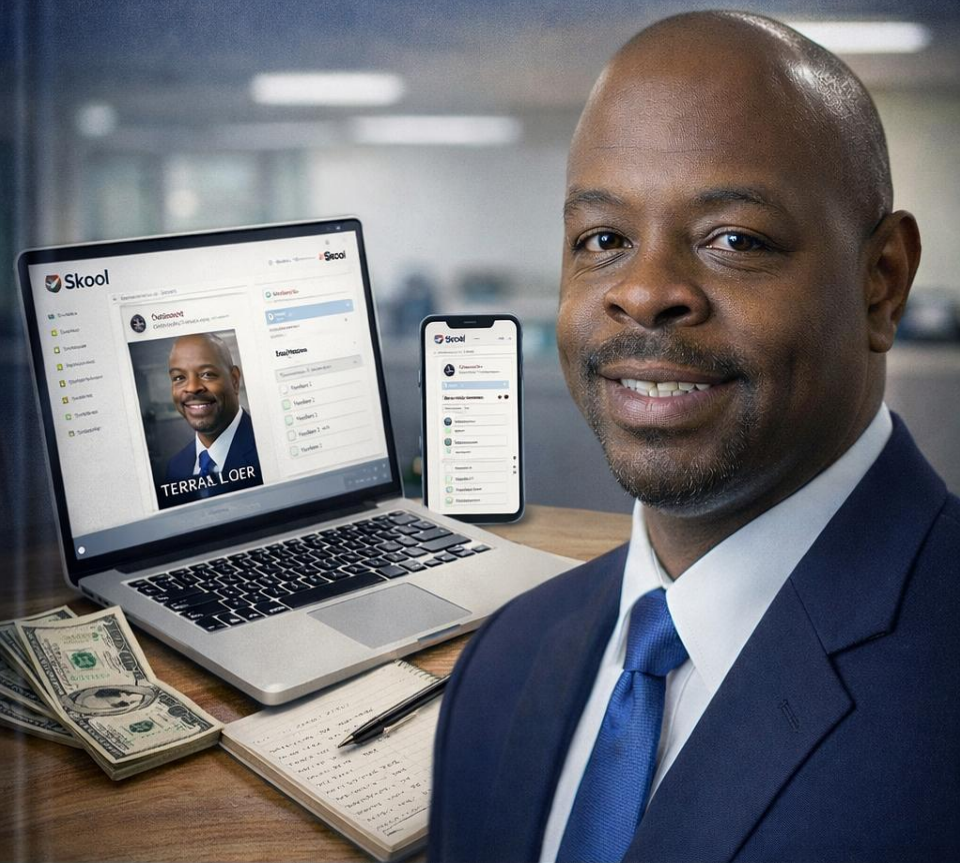


FROM PEN TO PLATFORM

How to Write, Publish, and
Build a Skool that Pays



TERRANCE GEE

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📖 From Pen to Platform: How to
Write, Publish, and Build a Skool
That Pays

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First edition

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1

✧ Chapter 1: Why a Skool Community? (And Why You're the Perfect Leader)

Let me hit you with the truth right out the gate: you spend hours every week inside online communities already. Instagram? TikTok? Discord? Reddit? All of these are communities. You're already giving away your attention for free. The difference is—you're not getting paid for it.

So here's the million-dollar question:

☞ What if you owned the community?

That's where **Skool** comes in.

What is Skool?

Skool is like if **Facebook Groups, Zoom, and Google Classroom had a baby—and then raised that baby in church with Christian values**. It's an all-in-one platform where you can:

Teach (upload lessons like a mini-course).

Build community (students talk, share wins, and support each other).

Monetize (charge monthly membership fees).

Think of it as **your digital classroom + church small group + side hustle = in one app**.

Why You're the Perfect Leader

I can already hear you: *"Me? Lead a community? I barely lead myself to get out of bed in the morning."*

But listen—every leader starts somewhere. Moses stuttered, David was the youngest shepherd boy, and the disciples were regular fishermen. God still used them.

If you've got a story, a lesson, or even just the willingness to learn and share—you qualify.

Why Skool Beats Social Media

No algorithm games. Your students see your content directly.

Safe space. You set the culture. No trolls, no random distractions.

Monetization built in. Unlike TikTok views that pay pennies, you set your price.

Viral Celebrity Comparison

Think of Skool like starting your own Netflix. Instead of watching *Stranger Things*, your members binge YOUR wisdom. Instead of subscribing to Spotify Premium, they subscribe to YOU.

You're not just scrolling anymore—you're streaming.

Faith Principle

Genesis 1:28 — “Be fruitful and multiply, and fill the earth and subdue it.”

Multiplication isn't just about kids. It's about multiplying gifts, ideas, and communities. Skool lets you multiply your influence, and God can multiply the impact.

Humor Break

Starting your own Skool community is like being the DJ at your own party. You set the playlist, you set the vibe, and everybody else just vibes out. No more begging for likes—you're running the show.

Quick Exercise

Write down:

The topic you'd love to teach (example: how to write your first book, how to get into real estate, how to heal after trauma).

Who you'd want to help (example: teens, single moms, young entrepreneurs).

Congrats—you just wrote the mission statement for your first Skool.

2

✧ Chapter 2: The Power of Storytelling — Writing Your First 40-Page eBook

Alright, let's get to the real sauce. Before you launch a Skool community, you need something to TEACH. And nothing screams “expert” louder than having your own eBook.

Why 40 Pages?

- **It's short enough to finish.** You can knock it out in 2–3 weeks.
- **It's long enough to have value.** 40 pages = legit book, not just a pamphlet.
- **It's the perfect starter product.** You can turn it into an audiobook, paperback, AND course material later.

Practical steps.(Notice we're literally doing this right now.)

How to Write Your eBook (Step by Step)

1. **Pick a Topic That Solves a Problem** Don't overthink it. What's something you know that can help others?
 - Example: "How I went from broke to saving \$1,000 in 60 days."
 - Example: "How to find your purpose at 19."
1. **Break It Into 10–12 Chapters** Think of each chapter as a short motivational talk.
 - 1. **Write Like You Talk** Forget grammar police. Write how you'd explain it to your little cousin.
 - Example: Instead of "Leverage your resources," say "Use what you got until you get what you want."
 - 1. **Add Faith + Humor** Sprinkle in scripture and jokes. Keep it real but grounded in truth.
 - Example: "Peter denied Jesus 3 times... some of y'all deny your dreams 3 times before breakfast."
 - 1. **Aim for 1,000 Words Per Chapter** 12 chapters × 1,000 words = 12,000 words ≈ 40 pages. Done.

Storytelling = Currency

People don't remember stats. They remember **stories**. Jesus didn't teach with pie charts—He told parables.

Your story is the hook. Your lessons are the message. Your book is the ministry.

Humor Break

Writing a 40-page eBook is like cooking ramen noodles. Cheap, fast, and everybody can do it. The difference? An eBook actually pays you back.

Faith Principle

📖 Habakkuk 2:2 — “Write the vision and make it plain, so that he may run who reads it.”

Your 40-page book is the **vision made plain**. Someone out there is waiting to run with it.

Quick Exercise

Today, write out a list of 5 chapter titles for your future eBook. Don't overthink—just write what pops in your head. Boom. That's your starter outline.

3

✧ Chapter 3: Turning Words into Sound — Creating an Audiobook

So you've got your 40-page eBook drafted out. Now it's time to make people **hear your story**—literally.

Why? Because not everyone reads. Some folks only listen: in the car, at the gym, while folding laundry, or while pretending to study. That's where audiobooks come in.

Why Audiobooks Matter

- **Accessibility.** Some people learn better by hearing.
- **Convenience.** Students can listen anywhere.
- **Extra money.** You're not just selling one product—you're flipping the same book in multiple formats.

It's like Chick-fil-A selling the same chicken as nuggets, sandwiches, and wraps. Different packaging, same chicken.

Options for Making an Audiobook

1. Free AI Tools

- *ElevenLabs (freemium)* → AI voices that sound real.
 - *Play.ht (freemium)* → upload text, download MP3.
 - *Speechify (low cost)* → plug in your eBook, let it talk.
1. 🎧 *Pro tip:* Pick a voice that matches your vibe. Don't let a British robot read your story about growing up in San Antonio.

1. DIY Recording (Broke but Ambitious Edition)

- Use your phone and a free app like GarageBand or Audacity.
- Sit in your closet (clothes absorb echo).
- Read your book out loud—just like telling your story to a friend.

1. Level Up with Fiverr

- If you've got \$50–\$100, hire a voice actor to do it for you.
- But make sure they don't sound like Siri.

Humor Break

Reading your own audiobook can be dangerous. You'll start adding side comments that weren't in the book. Like:

“And then I realized faith is the key... (pause)... also, shoutout to my grandma, she prayed me through rent that month.”

Faith Principle

📖 *Romans 10:17* — “So then faith comes by hearing, and hearing by the word of God.”

See that? **Faith comes by hearing.** That's why your audiobook matters—it plants seeds in people's ears.

Quick Exercise

Record yourself reading one chapter of your eBook using just your phone. Don't worry about perfection. Just listen back to hear how it feels.

Boom. That's your audiobook journey started.

4

✧ Chapter 4: Paper Dreams — Turning Your eBook into a KDP Paperback

Now let's make your words **real**. I'm talking about *physical, hold-it-in-your-hand, grandma-can-read-it-at-church* kind of real.

That's where **Amazon KDP (Kindle Direct Publishing)** comes in.

Why Print Matters

- **Credibility.** People take you more seriously when you've got a book they can hold.
- **Visibility.** Your book goes on Amazon—right next to the greats.
- **Legacy.** An eBook lives on devices. A paperback lives on shelves.

Imagine walking into your old high school one day and seeing your book in the library. That's flex + legacy.

How Amazon KDP Works

1. Format Your Manuscript

- Write in Google Docs or Word.
- Save as PDF.
- Keep margins clean, fonts readable (Times New Roman, 12pt).

1. Create a Cover

- Canva has free KDP cover templates.
 - Use bold colors and clean fonts.
 - Add your name big and clear.
1. 🗣 Remember: People DO judge books by their covers.
Don't use Comic Sans.

2. Upload to KDP

- Go to kdp.amazon.com.
- Create an account.
- Upload manuscript + cover.
- Set your price (usually \$9.99–\$14.99).

1. Publish & Print on Demand

- No need to buy 500 copies.
- Amazon prints your book every time someone orders it.
- You get royalties every month.

Humor Break

Holding your first paperback feels like holding your newborn baby. Except this baby doesn't cry, doesn't need diapers, and actually pays you money.

Faith Principle

📖 John 1:14 — “*The Word became flesh and made his dwelling among us.*”

That's literally what you're doing. Your word becomes *flesh on paper*. Your book becomes alive in the real world.

Quick Exercise

Go on Canva right now and design a fake book cover with your name and title idea. Print it out, tape it on a notebook, and hold it in your hands. That's a vision-board moment.

5

✧ Chapter 5: Why Teaching What You Create Makes You Rich

Okay, so now you've got a **trifecta of products**:

- eBook 📖
- Audiobook 🎧
- Paperback 📚

But here's the real question: how do you turn all of that into a movement, a business, and a blessing for others?

Answer: **TEACH it.**

The "Teacher Effect"

When you teach something you've done, 3 magical things happen:

1. **You become the authority.** People trust teachers more than random opinion-givers.

2. **You get paid for your experience.** Your failures become lessons someone else pays to skip.
3. **You multiply impact.** Instead of helping one person at a time, you help many at once.

Think about it—Jesus taught 12 disciples who then taught thousands. Multiplication.

Content → Course → Community → Cashflow

This is the blueprint:

- Write your story = content.
- Record lessons from your book = course.
- Create a Skool group = community.
- Charge a membership = cashflow.

And boom—you're not just an author, you're a **CEO of your own knowledge business.**

Humor Break

You know you're officially a teacher when you start repeating yourself like your grandma.

"I said wash the dishes... did you hear me? Wash. The. Dishes."

That's how you'll sound teaching your Skool students—but hey, repetition works.

Faith Principle

 2 Timothy 2:2 — *"The things you have heard me say... entrust to reliable people who will also be qualified to teach others."*

Paul said it best: what you learn, teach. That's how knowledge keeps multiplying.

Quick Exercise

Write down 3 lessons from your life that you'd be confident teaching to someone younger than you. Congrats—you just wrote your first Skool curriculum outline.

6

✧ Chapter 6: Setting Up Your Skool Community (Step-by-Step)

Time to go from dreamer to builder. Let's set up your **Skool classroom**.

Step 1: Choose Your Topic

Your Skool needs a clear mission. Keep it focused. Examples:

- “How to Write and Publish Your First Book”
- “Faith + Finances for Young Adults”
- “Turning Pain into Purpose: A Healing Journey”

Pick ONE. Don't try to teach crypto, cooking, and cat training all in the same group.

Step 2: Create Your Skool Account

- Go to skool.com.
- Sign up (basic free trial, then \$99/month when you're ready to scale).
- Name your group something catchy + faith-driven. Example: "Kingdom Creators Hub."

Step 3: Build Out Categories

Think of categories like folders in your classroom. Suggested ones:

- **Lessons** (recorded teachings).
- **Q&A** (members ask questions).

- **Community Wins** (testimonies + praise reports).
- **General Chat** (keep it fun, memes allowed).

Step 4: Write the Culture Rules

If you don't set rules, your group will feel like a chaotic group chat. Keep it faith-based and safe. Example rules:

- No hate speech.
- Respect everyone's journey.
- Keep it Kingdom (no spam, no scams).

Step 5: Add Your First Lesson

Upload a 5–10 minute intro video:

- Who you are.
- What the Skool is about.
- Why you started it.
- How people can get the most out of it.

Humor Break

When you make your first welcome video, don't worry if you feel awkward. Everybody's first video looks like they're reading a hostage note. You'll loosen up.

Faith Principle

📖 *Matthew 18:20* — “For where two or three gather in my name, there am I with them.”

That's literally what your Skool is: an online gathering spot

where God shows up too.

Quick Exercise

Go on Skool and make a free trial group today. Call it your “beta classroom.” Invite 1–2 friends just to test it out.

7

✧ Chapter 7: Making Your Skool Pop (So People Actually Want to Join)

Listen—nobody joins a boring group. If your Skool looks dry, feels dead, and has zero energy, people will bounce faster than a TikTok scroll.

Your mission? Make your community **irresistible**.

1. *Brand It Like It's Netflix*

- **Name matters.** Don't call your group "My Book Club 2025." Snooze. Instead: "*Faith Hustlers Academy*" or "*Kingdom Builders Society*."
- **Design counts.** Use Canva to create a clean logo + banner.
- **Vibes rule.** Every post, every lesson should feel like YOUR vibe—authentic, funny, faith-filled.

2. *Make It Fun to Engage*

- Start threads like:
- “Drop your weekly win below 🙌”
- “What verse got you through this week?”
- “Meme Monday: Only Christian memes allowed ”
- Give points & shoutouts. Gamification makes people feel seen.

3. *Give Viral Energy*

Use celebrity references to make lessons stick:

- “Think of your faith walk like Beyoncé’s Coachella set—rehearsed, consistent, world-shaking.”
- “Consistency is like Steph Curry’s 3-point shot—automatic.”
- “Don’t ghost on your calling like Kanye ghosted on Twitter.”

Humor Break

Your Skool needs to feel like Chick-fil-A on a Sunday... oh wait. Bad example. Let’s try again:

Your Skool needs to feel like **the one cookout everyone shows**

up to—good food, good music, good vibes, and that one uncle telling corny jokes.

Faith Principle

📖 Psalm 133:1 — “How good and pleasant it is when God’s people live together in unity!”

Unity makes communities thrive. When people feel connected, they’ll keep coming back.

Quick Exercise

Create a “Welcome Post” in your Skool group. Include:

- A funny meme
- A Bible verse
- A challenge (“Introduce yourself with your favorite gospel song”).

That’s instant engagement.

8

✧ Chapter 8: Monetizing Without Being Sleazy

Alright, let's address the elephant in the room: **money**.

Yes, your Skool can and should make money. But there's a difference between Kingdom entrepreneurship and scammy snake-oil vibes.

The Kingdom Money Mindset

- Money isn't evil. The **love** of money is.
- Charging for your knowledge isn't wrong—it's stewardship.
- When people invest, they commit. Free advice is usually ignored.

Ways to Monetize Your Skool

1. Membership Fees

- \$10–\$30/month = entry-level (good for young adults).
- \$50–\$100/month = premium (extra coaching/Q&A calls).

1. Tiered Access

- Free tier = community chat + some resources.
- Paid tier = full courses, live calls, personal coaching.

1. Upsell Your Products

- Your eBook = \$9.99
- Audiobook = \$19.99
- Paperback = \$14.99
- Bundle inside your Skool = value pack.

The “No Sleaze” Rule

- Don’t guilt people.
- Don’t promise “get rich quick.”
- Lead with value, then offer the paid upgrade.

Think Chick-fil-A again: they give you a free sample nugget first. Then you end up buying the 12-count combo.

Humor Break

The sleazy way to sell: “Buy my course or you’ll be broke forever.”

The Kingdom way to sell: “Here’s free value—if you want to go deeper, I’ve got something special for you.”

One makes people roll their eyes. The other makes people say “take my money.”

Faith Principle

📖 *Proverbs 11:25 — “A generous person will prosper; whoever refreshes others will be refreshed.”*

When you serve generously first, God will handle the prospering part.

Quick Exercise

Decide today: will your Skool start free and later add a paid tier, or will you charge from day one? Write down your first price point.

✧ Chapter 9: Marketing Your Skool Like It's a Mixtape

Look, you can build the dopest Skool in the world, but if nobody knows it exists... it's like making a mixtape and hiding it under your bed.

You gotta get **LOUD** about it—but in a way that's fun, faith-driven, and authentic.

1. *Social Media is Your Pulpit*

- **TikTok & Reels:** Drop 30-second clips teaching quick lessons from your book.
- **Instagram Stories:** Show behind-the-scenes of your Skool life.
- **YouTube Shorts:** Record “mini sermons” with practical tips.

⇒ Use hooks like:

- “Here’s how I turned my life around with one chapter...”
- “This one verse saved me when I was broke and broken...”
- “3 reasons your book idea is sitting in your head and not blessing others.”

2. Give Free Value First

- Host a free Zoom workshop: “*How to Write Your First 10 Pages.*”
- Post a free PDF checklist: “*5 Steps to Turning Your eBook into a Paperback.*”
- Share testimonies: show how your content changes lives.

When people taste the free sample, they’ll want the full meal.

3. Street Team Energy

Remember when rappers used to hand out CDs in parking lots? Same vibe—just digital.

- DM people personally with a kind, faith-driven invite.
- Ask your early members to share with friends.
- Make it feel like joining a **movement**, not just a class.

Humor Break

Marketing your Skool is like sliding into someone's DMs. If you come on too strong—blocked. If you're smooth, funny, and genuine—accepted.

Faith Principle

📖 *Matthew 5:14* — “You are the light of the world. A town built on a hill cannot be hidden.”

Your Skool is your light. Don't hide it—market it so it shines.

Quick Exercise

Write a 15-second TikTok script where you invite people to your Skool. Make it funny, bold, and faith-filled. Record it on your phone today.

10

✧ Chapter 10: Keeping People Engaged Long-Term

Okay—you've got people in your Skool. But now what? If your community feels dead, folks will ghost faster than a bad Tinder date.

The secret? **Consistency + creativity + care.**

1. *Weekly Rhythm*

Pick a weekly schedule so people know what to expect:

- Monday Motivation (drop a scripture + challenge).
- Wednesday Wins (let members share victories).
- Friday Faith + Fun (meme dump, Q&A, or game).

2. *Spotlight Members*

Everyone loves recognition.

- Give “Member of the Month” shoutouts.
- Highlight testimonies.
- Encourage peer-to-peer teaching.

3. *Live Calls = Community Glue*

Do at least 1 live call a month. It doesn't need to be fancy.

- Zoom works.
- Keep it 45–60 minutes.
- Mix teaching + prayer + Q&A.

Pro tip: Record it and upload it to Skool for those who miss it.

4. *Surprise Value Drops*

Randomly give free gifts:

- Bonus lessons.
- EBook templates.
- Playlists of faith-based pump-up music.

Surprise = delight.

Humor Break

Running a Skool is like being the host of a cookout. If you stop putting food on the grill, people stop showing up. Keep the burgers coming.

Faith Principle

📖 Galatians 6:9 — “Let us not become weary in doing good, for at the proper time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up.”

Even when engagement dips, don’t quit. Consistency builds community.

Quick Exercise

Create a 4-week posting plan for your Skool: what you’ll post every Monday, Wednesday, and Friday. Keep it simple but consistent.

11

✧ Chapter 11: Scaling Beyond Yourself (So You Don't Burn Out)

Listen, if you try to run your Skool, write books, record audio-books, design Canva covers, AND answer 57 DMs a day all by yourself... you're gonna burn out quicker than a Walmart candle.

Scaling means building systems so the mission doesn't die when you take a nap.

1. *Automate the Basics*

- **Schedule posts:** Use Skool's scheduling feature or a free tool like Buffer.
- **Templates:** Create reusable outlines for lessons, posts, and emails.
- **Payments:** Let Skool handle subscriptions so you're not chasing CashApp requests like a bill collector.

2. *Delegate Smartly*

Bring in helpers:

- A **moderator** to keep the group positive + spam-free.
- A **student leader** who loves sharing testimonies.
- A **VA (Virtual Assistant)** for cheap on Fiverr/Upwork to handle emails + graphics.

3. *Build Partnerships*

- Collaborate with other Skool creators for cross-promotion.
- Invite guest speakers (pastors, entrepreneurs, even viral TikTokers).
- Build bridges, not silos.

4. *Turn Students Into Teachers*

The ultimate scale move: your students start teaching new students. That's multiplication—just like Jesus did with the disciples.

Humor Break

Scaling without systems is like trying to fry chicken, answer FaceTime calls, and iron clothes at the same time. Something's gonna burn—and it's usually the chicken. *✍*

Faith Principle

📖 *Exodus 18:21-22* — “Select capable men... and appoint them as officials... That will make your load lighter, because they will share it with you.”

Even Moses had to delegate. Don't try to be the savior—you're the steward.

Quick Exercise

Write down 3 things you do for your Skool that someone else could do for \$5–\$10/hr. Congrats—you just made your first outsourcing list.

12

✧ Chapter 12: Leaving a Faith Legacy (The Bigger Picture)

Here's the truth: writing an eBook, recording an audiobook, printing a paperback, and building a Skool isn't just about making money. It's about **legacy**.

1. Your Book Lives Longer Than You

Long after you're gone, your words will still be alive in someone's hands, earbuds, or bookshelf. That's impact.

2. Your Community Creates Generational Ripples

One student you teach today might break generational poverty tomorrow.

One testimony in your Skool might lead to an entire family coming to Christ.

That's bigger than profits—it's eternal fruit.

3. Money is a Tool, Not the Goal

Yes, monetize. Yes, get paid. But don't forget: the money is just a resource to build bigger impact. Churches, nonprofits, shelters, scholarships—those need Kingdom entrepreneurs.

Humor Break

Imagine your great-grandkids finding your old eBook and audiobook one day...

“Wait, Grandpa was teaching people how to turn books into audiobooks? Man was ahead of his time.”

Faith Principle

 *Proverbs 13:22 — “A good person leaves an inheritance for their children’s children.”*

Your inheritance isn't just money. It's wisdom, faith, and courage that lives on through your work.

The Final Call

Young kings and queens, here's your roadmap:

1. Write the eBook.
2. Record the audiobook.
3. Print the paperback.
4. Build the Skool.
5. Teach, scale, and leave a legacy.

You're not just creating products—you're creating a movement.
You're not just hustling—you're kingdom-building.

So go. Start. Today. Because someone's future testimony is waiting for your obedience right now.

